Reviewer 1: Anonymous

Comments to authors:
The article “Data error due to phenol used as a positive control in cytotoxicity test methods” by
Girish K Srivastava et al has attempted to test the toxicity of phenol in the experimental set up and error in cytotoxicity data from the neighboring wells which could be cause of concern while presenting the results. Manuscript is found to be presented well, especially the ‘introduction’ and ‘discussion and conclusion’ part, however, the experimental groups and results are not clear in terms of their description with the images of 96-well plates. The manuscript needs to be revised on the line of following points which may help improve the manuscript and make it publishable.

1) There is no ‘Error bar’ in any of the graphical results. All the data presented to prove the concept is based on graph only, therefore, it is needed to put the statistical characteristics for confirmation. Also the set of each groups (wells) should be mentioned i.e. n = ?. For example, in L1, L2, L3 and L4, it is difficult to identify whether they are grouped as triplicate or represent only a single well. Either numbering, grouping or description of the wells is not done properly.
2) In section “Cell culture plate preparation” author should describe the rationale for growing cells with two different densities which are 10,000 cells/well and 5,000 cells/well while the treatment condition and time duration is same for both.
3) In Figure 1B, L2 and L4 should not be adjacent to each other as L4 may show false positive result because of L2, therefore, their individual effect may not be accurate.
4) Figure 1A should also be labelled as its legend is describing different groups and wells.
5) Section “Short period phenol incubation effect” - It is describing b1 (neighbor to L2)…, while in the image (1B), b1 is far from L2.
6) Figure 5- experiment states to be conducted on L929 cells, however, in the same result ARPE-19 cells are mentioned to be used.
7) Many typographical and grammatical errors are present in the manuscript, for example ‘(group e1, e2, 23, e4)’ in figure legends, ‘that that’ in result section etc. which need to be corrected.